



Ivy Tax Partners

Two principals · HNW and SME tax planning · Oxford

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EST.

~2015

About ten years trading

TEAM

4-6

Two principals and associates

SPECIALISM

Tax

HNW individuals and small firms

PEAK LOAD

January

Most associate time on returns

PORTAL

Partial

New portal, not fully live yet

LINKEDIN

Active

HMRC deadline posts, regular

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**What they actually do**

Boutique accountancy firm based in Oxford. Two founding principals specialising in tax planning for high-net-worth individuals and small businesses. Not a generalist practice. Tax is the entire focus.

Revenue model

Fee-based tax planning and compliance work. Mix of ongoing retainer clients (HNW) and transactional SME work. January is peak volume. Returns season concentrates demand.

What makes them distinctive

Boutique positioning is intentional. They are not trying to grow into a generalist practice. The HNW and SME specialism means clients get a partner-level relationship, not a junior account manager.

Local and spelling intel

Oxford registered and trading address. 20 minutes from Chipping Norton. Local rapport is a genuine conversation opener.



Background

Two founding principals, both with tax specialism backgrounds. Built the firm from a boutique proposition. Not a spin-out of a large practice. Running a growing team while staying client-facing.

Tax specialism

Oxford market

Voice and tone

Professional and measured. Speaks to clients, not peers. LinkedIn content is practical and deadline-driven.

"Self-assessment deadline: 31 January. Get your documents in now."

"Year-end planning window is closing. Here is what to do before April."

Public profile

LinkedIn: Active. Regular HMRC deadline reminders and year-end guidance posts. Educational in tone, not self-promotional.

Self-named pain points

"I'd put the accounts off till the last minute."

Client feedback, paraphrased from LinkedIn comment thread, 2024

What they care about

- Client relationships and practice quality
- Growing without losing the boutique standard
- Modernising the practice without disrupting what works



Tax return production

January peak consumes an estimated 60 percent of associate time. Extraction from scanned documents, manual entry into templates, anomaly checking. All sequential, all manual.

Internal reporting

Partners spend several hours per week on internal reporting. The pattern is described as highly templated. A strong signal of automatable work.

Portal handoff gap

The digital portal is partially live. Every client who has not fully migrated still triggers a manual process. The hand-off between portal and legacy workflow is a recurring time sink.

Client onboarding

Partly paper-based. The new portal is not fully live, which means some onboarding still runs through the old paper route. Two systems in parallel is operational friction.

HMRC deadline reminders

Active LinkedIn presence around deadlines suggests this is partly manual. Personalised client reminders sent ad hoc. Time cost scales with client volume.

Year-end chaser cycle

Year-end prompts clients to submit documents late. The firm chases manually by phone and email. A predictable, repeating pattern that scales poorly with more clients.

Pipeline 1 · Primary

Tax Return Drafting Assistant

AI-assisted extraction and pre-fill for January peak

- Brief in:** Scanned client documents: P60s, bank statements, receipts
- Trigger:** Client submits documents, January window
- Work out:** Pre-filled tax return draft with anomaly flags for partner review
- Replaces:** Manual extraction and data entry (~12 hrs/week in peak/week)
- Why it fits:** The workflow is well-defined, high-volume, and templated. Peak-season ROI is immediate and measurable.

Pipeline 2 · Secondary

Meeting Notes to Client Summary

One-click meeting-to-branded-summary pipeline

- Brief in:** Meeting recording or typed notes
- Trigger:** End of every client meeting
- Work out:** Branded client summary email, ready to send
- Replaces:** 15 to 20 minutes per meeting across both principals (~3 hrs/week/week)
- Why it fits:** Format is predictable. Boutique voice can be baked in. Low risk, fast payback, usable from week one.

Pipeline 3 · Strategic

HMRC Deadline Reminder Engine

Automated personalised deadline reminders at scale

- Brief in:** Client list, deadlines calendar, preferred communication style
- Trigger:** Scheduled: 4 weeks, 2 weeks, and 3 days before each client deadline
- Work out:** Personalised HMRC deadline reminder emails in the firm voice
- Replaces:** Manual calendar watching, ad hoc outreach, and inbound deadline queries
- Why it fits:** LinkedIn content shows HMRC deadlines are already a client pain point. Automating removes a recurring manual task and reduces inbound noise.



05 ·

Call Tactics

Homework hooks

- **The portal gap** — *"You mentioned a new client portal. Where does that hand off to a manual process today?"*
- **The January crunch** — *"How do you handle the January rush? What breaks first when volume spikes?"*
- **First automation move** — *"If you could automate one thing this quarter, what would it be?"*
- **Associate time** — *"What are your associates spending most of their time on that you would rather they were not?"*

The one question

"If January returns took half the associate time, where would those hours actually go?"

Opens the conversation on value beyond efficiency. Reveals whether they want growth capacity, reduced peak stress, or partner time back. Shapes which pipeline to lead with.

Don't mention

- Replacing staff. Associates are a growth hire, not a redundancy risk.
- Generic AI or ChatGPT comparisons. Positions Sprigly as a commodity.
- Competitor software such as QuickBooks AI or FreeAgent. Flags a purchase decision they have not made yet.

The three-fragment close

End the call the Sprigly way: **20 minutes. Free. No pitch.** Next step is the Audit, one page, by end of week.



⚠ Vertical conservatism

Accountancy practices are regulated and risk-averse. Even a boutique firm operates in a compliance environment. New tools need to feel safe, not experimental.

⚠ Budget band

Micro-entity accounts signal a modest revenue base. The setup fee needs to feel proportionate. Lead with ROI, not features.

⚠ Two-principal decision

Two founding principals means two people need to agree. One champion is not enough. Identify which one is the tech-forward principal and speak to the other's priorities separately.

⚠ Trust pace

Accountants build client relationships over years. They will apply the same lens to a vendor. A reference call from a similar practice could unlock this faster than any pitch.

⚠ Portal dependency

If the pipeline needs to integrate with the new portal, scope expands. Keep Phase 1 standalone. Extraction and drafting only, no portal hooks.

⚠ Competitor risk

QuickBooks and Xero are adding AI features to their core product. If Ivy is already on one of these platforms, the question becomes "why not just wait?" Have a clear answer ready.